

Advertisement

APPS



Weekly subscriptions dominate iOS app revenue, report finds

Weekly subscriptions have now become one of the most popular ways iOS apps are earning revenue, with these plans contributing 46% to the bottom line, according to [a new report](#) by app revenue management platform Adapty.

The study, which observed \$1.9 billion in revenue across more than 11,000 apps, noted that weekly plans have grown by 9.5% this year compared to one-time purchases, which grew by 6.3% in the first quarter. Other paid plans, including monthly, yearly, and lifetime subscriptions, dipped in growth.

Adapty said that prices of weekly plans have also increased along with the growth. Average weekly subscription prices in the EU and the U.S. have grown 12.2% and 12.5% respectively to \$8.3 and \$8.1. In comparison, monthly and annual plans have seen mixed growth in different regions. App makers like Spotify and Canva have experimented with weekly plans in multiple markets.



IMAGE CREDITS: ADAPTY



IMAGE CREDITS: ADAPTY



IMAGE CREDITS: ADAPTY

The report noted that the U.S. is leading with 48.9% of contributions to in-app purchases, with Europe in second place with a 24.8% contribution. It also said that U.S. installs bring 3-4 times more revenue than installs from other regions.

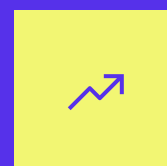
TECH DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)

Most Popular

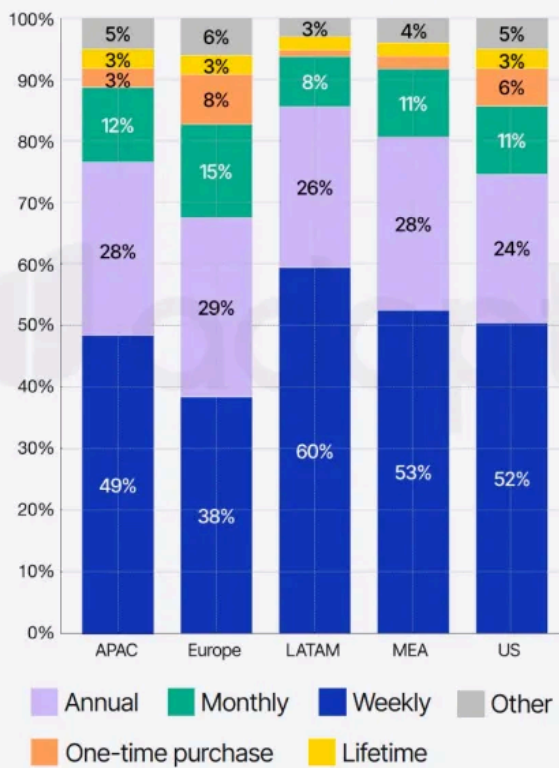


- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

In all regions, weekly plans were the top contributors to revenue. Most notably, these plans generated 60% of revenue in LATAM, followed by 53% in MEA. In Europe, while weekly plans were the biggest money driver, they had a share of 38%.

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps

Share of revenue split by subscription duration across regions



10

IMAGE CREDITS: ADAPTY

There is a downside to the rise in weekly plans as it becomes harder for apps to retain users after a few weeks.

“What accelerates growth also limits lifetime value. Weekly plans thrive in burst-use categories, like utilities or quick productivity tools, where users pay for immediate value but rarely stay. Retention drops sharply after day 30, and only single-digit percentages remain after a year. That churn curve quietly erodes marketing ROI,” Appfigures founder and CEO Ariel Michaeli said in the report.

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

The report noted that weekly plans drive better lifetime value from consumers in categories like productivity and utility. However, in categories such as Health & Fitness and Photo & Video, annual plans drive value.

Adapty also said that developers offering trials before providing a subscription saw positive results, with app makers seeing 64% and 58% increases in lifetime value in the U.S. and Europe, respectively.

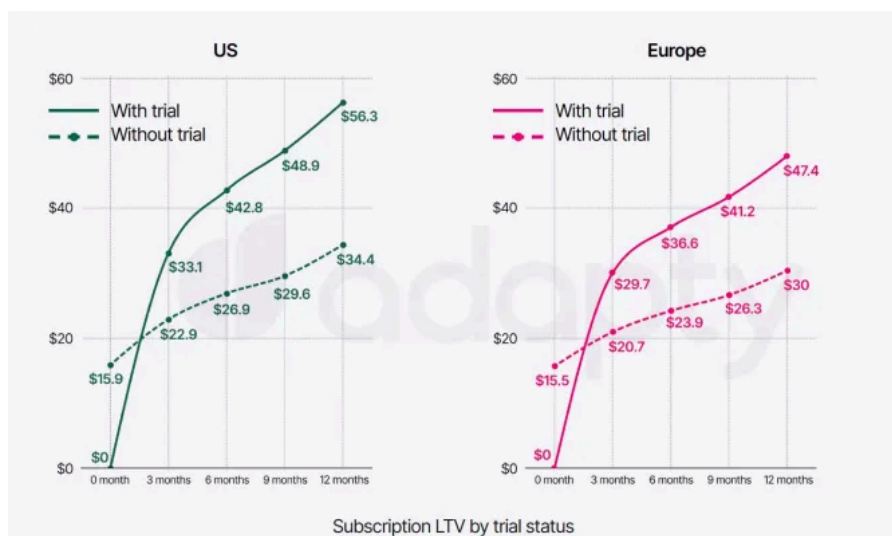


IMAGE CREDITS: ADAPTY

Apple is facing regulatory pressure to change its App Store model thanks to rulings in both [the U.S.](#) and [the EU](#). However, Adapty thinks that we might not see immediate effects.

“We’ve spoken with some of the biggest players in the space, and honestly, there’s no major shift toward third-party payments yet. The drop in conversion tends to cancel out most of the upside. There’s also talk that Apple might lower its cut to 15-20% globally, and if that happens, the value of going external gets a lot harder to justify,” Vitaly Davydov, CEO of Adapty, said.

Topics: [app store](#) [Apps](#) [in app purchases](#) [iOS](#)

[subscriptions](#)

[f](#) [X](#) [in](#) [reddit](#) [email](#) [link](#)



Ivan Mehta

[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

[View Bio](#) >

———— KEEP READING ————



Apple tries to delay ruling that bars it from taking a cut on external app payments

Ivan Mehta, Ram Iyer

3:02 AM PDT · May 8, 2025

In an attempt to protect a valuable revenue stream, Apple is trying to delay a court ruling that forces the company to let iOS app developers in the U.S. redirect users to external payment systems and avoid paying a commission to the iPhone maker.

IMAGE CREDITS: BRYCE DURBIN / TECHCRUNCH

The company filed [an emergency motion](#) late on Wednesday, asking an appeals court to grant a partial stay on [a previous ruling](#).

A U.S. court last week [ruled in favor of Epic Games](#) in a long-running case against Apple, after Judge Yvonne Gonzalez Rogers found that Apple did not comply with an order that was handed down in 2021.

The new ruling forces Apple to let apps on its U.S. App Store include features that could [redirect users](#)

Newsletters

See More ↗

Subscribe for the industry's biggest tech news

TechCrunch Daily News



Every weekday and Sunday, you can get the best of TechCrunch's coverage.

Startups Weekly



Startups are the core of TechCrunch, so get our best coverage delivered weekly.

TechCrunch Week in Review



Latest

Security

Startups

AI

Venture

Apps

Apple

[Events](#)
[Podcasts](#)
[Newsletters](#)

earlier injunction, as the court did not originally bar the company from charging commissions on non-Apple payment systems — Apple had not [started doing that](#) at the time.

Apple says it complied with the court’s 2021 injunction by letting developers link out to non-Apple payment systems. We must note that it charged app developers a 27% cut on those transactions anyway, in addition to showing the “scare screens” described above.

[Subscribe](#)

By submitting your email, you agree to our [Terms](#) and [Privacy Notice](#).



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

[REGISTER NOW](#)

The new order would result in significant losses, the company said. “These restrictions, which will cost Apple substantial sums annually, are based on

conduct that has never been adjudicated to be (and is not) unlawful; rather, they were imposed to punish Apple for purported non-compliance with an earlier state-law Injunction that is itself invalid,” it said in the filing.

“Without a stay, these extraordinary intrusions into Apple’s business will cause grave irreparable harm,” the company said.

Epic Games [reacted to Apple’s motion and said](#) it is a “last-ditch effort to block competition and extract massive junk fees at the expense of consumers and developers.”

The iPhone maker filed an appeal [against the court decision earlier this week](#). The company has already complied with the order and is allowing developers to link users out to complete purchases outside the App Store ecosystem. Companies like [Spotify](#) and Amazon have already updated their apps to redirect users to their own websites for payments.

The story has been updated with Epic Games’ statement.

Topics: [app store](#) [Apple](#) [Apps](#) [Commerce](#)

[Epic Games](#)



Ivan Mehta

[X](#) [in](#)

Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

[View Bio](#) >



Ram Iyer

Editor | [X](#)

Ram is a financial and tech reporter and editor. He covered North American and European M&A, equity, regulatory...

[View Bio](#) >

KEEP READING



Apple's StoreKit 2 simplifies App Store subscriptions and refunds by making them accessible inside apps

Sarah Perez — 8:43 AM PDT · June 10, 2021

IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

If you've ever bought a subscription inside an iOS app and later decided you wanted to cancel, upgrade or downgrade, or ask for a refund, you may have had trouble figuring out how to go about

making that request or change. Some people today still believe that they can stop their subscription charges simply by deleting an app from their iPhone. Others may dig around unsuccessfully inside their iPhone's Settings or on the App Store to try to find out how to ask for a refund. With the updates Apple announced in [StoreKit 2](#) during its Worldwide Developers Conference this week, things may start to get a little easier for app customers.

StoreKit is Apple's developer framework for managing in-app purchases — an area that's become more complex in recent years, as apps have transitioned from offering one-time purchases to ongoing subscriptions with different tiers, lengths and feature sets.



Introducing StoreKit 2

IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

Currently, users who want to manage or [cancel subscriptions](#) can do so from the App Store or their iPhone Settings. But some don't realize the path to this section from Settings starts by tapping on your Apple ID (your name and profile photo at the top of the screen). They may also get frustrated if they're not familiar with how to navigate their Settings or the App Store.

Meanwhile, there are a [variety of ways](#) users can request refunds on their in-app subscriptions. They can dig in their inbox for their receipt from Apple, then click the "Report a Problem" link it includes to request a refund when something went wrong. This could be useful in scenarios where you've bought a

Advertisement

Latest in Media & Entertainment

See More

AI



Google denies AI search features are killing website traffic

Sarah Perez - 15 hours ago

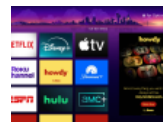
SOCIAL



Substack rival Ghost connects to the open social web with its latest public release

Sarah Perez - 2 days ago

MEDIA & ENTERTAINMENT



Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service

Aisha Malik - 2 days ago

Advertisement

subscription by mistake (or your kid has!), or where the promised features didn't work as intended.

Apple also [provides](#) a [dedicated website](#) where users can directly request refunds for apps or content. (When you Google for something like “request a refund apple” or similar queries, a page that explains the process typically comes up at the top of the search results.)

Still, many users aren't technically savvy. For them, the easiest way to manage subscriptions or ask for refunds would be to do so from within the app itself. For this reason, many conscientious app developers tend to include links to point customers to Apple's pages for subscription management or refunds inside their apps.

But StoreKit 2 is introducing new tools that will allow developers to implement these sort of features more easily.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

[REGISTER NOW](#)

One new tool is a Manage subscriptions API, which lets an app developer display the manage subscriptions page for their customer directly inside their app — without redirecting the customer to the App Store. Optionally, developers can choose to display a “Save Offer” screen to present the customer with a discount of some kind to keep them from cancelling, or it could display an exit survey so you can ask the customer why they decided to end their subscription.

When implemented, the customer will be able to view a screen inside the app that looks just like the one they’d visit in the App Store to cancel or change a subscription. After canceling, they’ll be shown a confirmation screen with the cancellation details and the service expiration date.

If the customer wants to request a refund, a new Refund request API will allow the customer to begin their refund request directly in the app itself — again, without being redirected to the App Store or other website. On the screen that displays, the customer can select for which item they want a refund and check the reason why they’re making the request. Apple handles the refund process and will send either an approval or refund declined notification back to the developer’s server.

However, some developers argue that the changes don’t go far enough. They want to be in charge of managing customer subscriptions and handling refunds themselves, through programmatic means. Plus, Apple can [take up to 48 hours](#) for the customer to receive an update on their refund request, which can be confusing. StoreKit 2 aims to address this by sending an email that confirms the refund request, noting the 48-hour window, and then a second one when the email has been processed, Apple says.

“They’ve made the process a bit smoother, but developers still can’t initiate refunds or cancellations themselves,” notes [RevenueCat](#) CEO Jacob Eiting, whose company [provides tools](#) to app developers to manage their in-app purchases. “It’s a step in the right direction, but could actually lead to more confusion between developers and consumers about who is responsible for issuing refunds.”

In other words, because the forms are now going to be more accessible from inside the app, the customer may believe the developer is handling the refund process when, really, Apple continues to do so.

People could write in after uninstalling the app. Or have subscribed on a device they no longer have. There are so many cases that this ignores.

This is only a marginal improvement over opening the manage subscriptions URL.

— Jacob Eiting — [iap/acc \(@jeiting\)](#) [June 8, 2021](#)

Some developers pointed out that there are other scenarios this process doesn’t address. For example, if the customer has already uninstalled the app or no longer has the device in question, they’ll still need to be directed to other means of asking for refunds, just as before.

For consumers, though, subscription management tools like this mean more developers may begin to put buttons to manage subscriptions and ask for refunds directly inside their app, which is a better experience. In time, as customers learn they can more easily use the app and manage subscriptions, app developers may see better customer retention, higher engagement, and better App Store reviews, notes Apple.

The new additions to SwiftUI, been wanting Pull to Refresh and to improve accessibility. Then surprisingly StoreKit 2, especially for users requesting refunds and managing subscriptions seamlessly (also great for Buffer).

— Andrew Yates (@ay8s) [June 8, 2021](#)

The StoreKit 2 changes weren't limited to APIs for managing subscriptions and refunds.

Developers will also gain access to a new Invoice Lookup API that allows them to look up the in-app purchases for the customer, validate their invoice and identify any problems with the purchase — for example, if there were any refunds already provided by the App Store.

A new Refunded Purchases API will allow developers to look up all the refunds for the customer.

Sounds like StoreKit can validate receipts on device and allow users to request refunds. Didn't have those on my bingo card but wow those are some nice quality-of-life updates!

— Conrad Stoll (@conradstoll) [June 7, 2021](#)

A new Renewal Extension API will allow developers to extend the renewal data for paid, active subscriptions in the case of an outage — like when dealing with customer support issues when a streaming service went down, for example. This API lets developers extend the subscription up to twice per calendar year, each up to 90 days in the future.

And finally, a new Consumption API will allow developers to share information about a customer's in-app purchase with the App Store. In most cases, customers begin consuming content soon after purchase — information that's helpful in the refund decision process. The API will allow the

App Store to see if the user consumed the in-app purchase partially, fully, or not at all.

Another change will help customers when they reinstall apps or download them on new devices. Before, users would have to manually “restore purchases” to sync the status of the completed transactions back to that newly downloaded or reinstalled app. Now, that information will be automatically fetched by StoreKit 2 so the apps are immediately up-to-date with whatever it is the user paid for.

Very interesting changes to StoreKit. Apps will now be able to automatically restore and sync purchases, so users won't need to restore when the app is reinstalled or downloaded on a new device!

<https://t.co/WSs6L9rTvK>

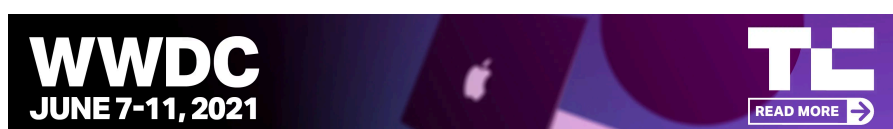
— Marcos Tanaka (@mactanaka) [June 8, 2021](#)

While, overall, the changes make for a significant update to the StoreKit framework, Apple’s hesitancy to allow developers more control over their own subscription-based customers speaks, in part, to how much it wants to control in-app purchases. This is perhaps because it got burned in the past when it tried allowing developers to manage their own refunds.

As [The Verge noted last month](#) while the Epic Games-Apple antitrust trial was underway, Apple had once provided Hulu with access to a subscription API, then discovered Hulu had been offering a way to automatically cancel subscriptions made through the App Store when customers wanted to upgrade to higher-priced subscription plans. Apple realized it needed to take action to protect against this misuse of the API, and Hulu later lost access. It has not since made that API more broadly available.

On the flip side, having Apple, not the developers, in charge of subscription management and refunds means Apple takes on the responsibilities around preventing fraud — including fraud perpetrated by both customers and developers alike. Customers may also prefer that there's one single place to go for managing their subscription billing: Apple. They may not want to have to deal with each developer individually, as their experience would end up being inconsistent.

These changes matter because subscription revenue contributes to a sizable amount of Apple's lucrative App Store business. Ahead of WWDC 21, Apple [reported](#) the sale of digital goods and services on the App Store grew to \$86 billion in 2020, up 40% over the the year prior. Earlier this year, Apple [said it paid out more than \\$200 billion](#) to developers since the App Store launched in 2008. During the WWDC 2021 keynote, it updated the number to \$230 billion.



Topics: [api](#) [app stores](#) [app-store](#) [Apple](#) [apple id](#)

[apple inc](#) [Apps](#) [Customer Service](#)

[developers](#) [iOS](#) [iPhone](#)

[Media & Entertainment](#) [Refunds](#) [RevenueCat](#)

[smartphones](#) [subscriptions](#) [WWDC 2021](#)

Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

[View Bio](#) >

Loading the next article

